ANATOMY · MCQ PRACTICE

Pelvis & Perineum — MCQ Practice

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GUE BLOCK

Anatomy GUE Block · MEDucation by Mattin Majid

HOW TO USE THIS SET

20 questions, 5 options each (A–E). Answer on paper or in your head, then check every answer against the key on the final page.

4 Easy · 10 Medium · 6 Hard · suggested time ≈ 25 minutes.

Q Questions

1. How many bones make up the bony pelvis? EASY

A. Two — the right and left hip bones
B. Three — two hip bones and the sacrum
C. Four — two hip bones, the sacrum and the coccyx
D. Five — two hip bones, sacrum, coccyx, L5
E. Six — ilium, ischium and pubis on each side

2. What type of joint is the symphysis pubis? EASY

A. Secondary cartilaginous (fibrocartilaginous)
B. Synovial plane joint
C. Primary cartilaginous (synchondrosis)
D. Fibrous syndesmosis
E. Synovial hinge joint

3. Which is the largest component of the pelvic diaphragm? EASY

A. Coccygeus
B. Obturator internus
C. Piriformis
D. Deep transverse perineal
E. Levator ani

4. What forms the posterior boundary of the pelvic outlet? EASY

A. Sacral promontory
B. Coccyx
C. Ala of the sacrum
D. Sacrospinous ligament
E. Iliopectineal line

5. Which structure forms the lateral boundary of the pelvic inlet? MEDIUM

A. Ischiopubic ramus and tuberosity
B. Sacrotuberous ligament
C. Ischial tuberosity
D. Iliopectineal (arcuate) line
E. Obturator membrane

6. The false (greater) pelvis lies above the pelvic brim. Which cavity is it part of? MEDIUM

A. The abdominal cavity
B. The true pelvic cavity
C. The perineum
D. The ischiorectal fossa
E. The deep perineal pouch

7. Pelvimetry shows a heart-shaped inlet, funnel-shaped cavity, narrow subpubic angle and a sacrum inclined forward. Which pelvis is this? MEDIUM

A. Gynecoid
B. Anthropoid
C. Android
D. Platypelloid
E. Mixed gynecoid–anthropoid

8. A woman's pelvis has an oval inlet whose anteroposterior diameter exceeds the transverse, a deep narrow cavity and a long narrow sacrum. Which type? MEDIUM

A. Android
B. Gynecoid
C. Platypelloid
D. Heart-shaped male type
E. Anthropoid

9. Which muscle forms part of the LATERAL wall of the pelvic cavity? MEDIUM

A. Piriformis
B. Obturator internus
C. Coccygeus
D. Quadratus lumborum
E. Levator ani

10. In a woman, which structures pass through the urogenital hiatus of the pelvic floor? MEDIUM

A. Anal canal only
B. Urethra only
C. Vagina and anal canal
D. Urethra and vagina
E. Pudendal nerve and vessels

11. Which muscle is a component of the pelvic diaphragm but NOT one of the three parts of levator ani? MEDIUM

A. Coccygeus
B. Puborectalis
C. Pubococcygeus
D. Iliococcygeus
E. Obturator internus

12. Years after a difficult vaginal delivery, a woman's uterus descends into the vagina. Tearing of which structure explains the weakened floor? MEDIUM

A. Anococcygeal body
B. Sacrospinous ligament
C. Perineal body
D. Perineal membrane
E. Obturator fascia

13. The perineum is divided into urogenital and anal triangles by an imaginary line passing through which landmarks? MEDIUM

A. The two anterior superior iliac spines
B. The two ischial spines
C. The pubic tubercles
D. The tip of the coccyx and the symphysis
E. The two ischial tuberosities

14. Which layer forms the inferior boundary (floor) of the superficial perineal pouch? MEDIUM

A. Perineal membrane (inferior fascia of UG diaphragm)
B. Membranous layer of superficial fascia (Colles')
C. Superior fascia of the UG diaphragm
D. Levator ani
E. Obturator internus fascia

15. A woman has a painful swelling from a gland in the superficial perineal pouch. Which gland is it? HARD

A. Cowper's gland
B. Paraurethral gland
C. Seminal vesicle
D. Bartholin's gland
E. Prostate

16. Which structure lies in the DEEP perineal pouch of a man? HARD

A. Intermediate (membranous) urethra
B. Bulb of the penis
C. Ischiocavernosus
D. Proximal spongy (bulbar) urethra
E. Superficial transverse perineal muscle

17. An ischiorectal abscess is drained. Which structure forms the LATERAL wall of the fossa? HARD

A. Levator ani and the anal canal
B. Obturator internus with its fascia
C. Skin of the perineum
D. Sacrotuberous and sacrospinous ligaments
E. Gluteus maximus

18. Which structures CROSS the ischiorectal fossa to reach the anal canal? HARD

A. Pudendal nerve and internal pudendal vessels
B. Obturator nerve and vessels
C. Superior rectal vessels
D. Sciatic nerve
E. Inferior rectal nerve and vessels

19. Which pairing of pelvis type and feature is correct? HARD

A. Gynecoid — heart-shaped inlet; narrow subpubic angle
B. Android — AP > transverse; long narrow sacrum
C. Anthropoid — short broad sacrum; shallow cavity; wide subpubic angle
D. Platypelloid — transverse > AP; engagement may be difficult
E. Gynecoid — funnel cavity; risk of difficult labour

20. What forms the SUPERIOR boundary of the deep perineal pouch? HARD

A. Perineal membrane
B. Membranous layer of superficial fascia
C. Superior fascia of the UG diaphragm
D. Levator ani
E. Ischiopubic rami

✓ Answer key

Q	Answer	Difficulty	Why
1	**C**	EASY	The bony pelvis has four bones: two hip bones, the sacrum and the coccyx.
2	**A**	EASY	The symphysis pubis is a secondary cartilaginous (fibrocartilaginous) joint, reinforced by superior and inferior ligaments.
3	**E**	EASY	Pelvic diaphragm = levator ani (largest) + coccygeus + their fascia.
4	**B**	EASY	Outlet: symphysis pubis in front, coccyx behind, ischiopubic rami anterolaterally, sacrotuberous ligaments posterolaterally.
5	**D**	MEDIUM	Inlet (brim): symphysis pubis in front, sacral promontory and ala behind, iliopectineal (arcuate) lines laterally.
6	**A**	MEDIUM	The false pelvis is part of the abdominal cavity; the true pelvis, below the brim, is the true pelvic cavity.
7	**C**	MEDIUM	Android: heart-shaped inlet, funnel cavity, narrow subpubic angle — resembles the male pelvis; increased risk of difficult labour.
8	**E**	MEDIUM	Anthropoid: AP > transverse diameter, deep and narrow cavity, long narrow sacrum; vaginal delivery is often possible.
9	**B**	MEDIUM	Lateral wall: hip bone, obturator membrane, obturator internus and fascia, sacrotuberous and sacrospinous ligaments. Piriformis is in the posterior wall.
10	**D**	MEDIUM	Urogenital hiatus (anterior): urethra, plus the vagina in females. The rectal hiatus (central) carries the anal canal.
11	**A**	MEDIUM	Levator ani = puborectalis, pubococcygeus, iliococcygeus. Coccygeus is a separate component of the pelvic diaphragm.
12	**C**	MEDIUM	Difficult childbirth can tear the perineal body; the pelvic diaphragm weakens and no longer supports the viscera → uterine (and rectal) prolapse.
13	**E**	MEDIUM	A transverse line through the two ischial tuberosities: urogenital triangle in front, anal triangle behind.
14	**B**	MEDIUM	Superficial pouch: inferiorly Colles' fascia, superiorly the perineal membrane, laterally the ischiopubic rami.
15	**D**	HARD	Female superficial pouch: vestibular bulbs, clitoral crura, three muscles and the greater vestibular (Bartholin's) glands. Cowper's (bulbourethral) glands are in the male deep pouch.
16	**A**	HARD	Male deep pouch: membranous urethra, external urethral sphincter, deep transverse perineal, bulbourethral glands, dorsal nerve and vessels of the penis. The rest are superficial.
17	**B**	HARD	Ischiorectal fossa: base skin, medial wall levator ani and anal canal, lateral wall obturator internus covered with fascia.
18	**E**	HARD	The inferior rectal nerve and vessels cross the fossa; the pudendal nerve and internal pudendal vessels stay in the pudendal (Alcock's) canal.
19	**D**	HARD	Platypelloid: wide flattened oval, transverse > AP, shallow, short broad sacrum — engagement of the fetal head may be difficult.
20	**C**	HARD	Deep pouch: inferiorly the perineal membrane, superiorly the superior fascia of the UG diaphragm, laterally the inferior part of the obturator internus fascia.